Rainwater harvesting is gathering, or accumulating and storing of rainwater. It has been used to provide drinking water, water for livestock, water for irrigation. Rain water collected from the roofs of houses, tents and local institutions or from specially prepared areas of ground makes an important contribution to drinking water. Roof rainwater is usually of good quality and does not require treatment before consumption.

8.2.1 Benefits of Rainwater Harvesting

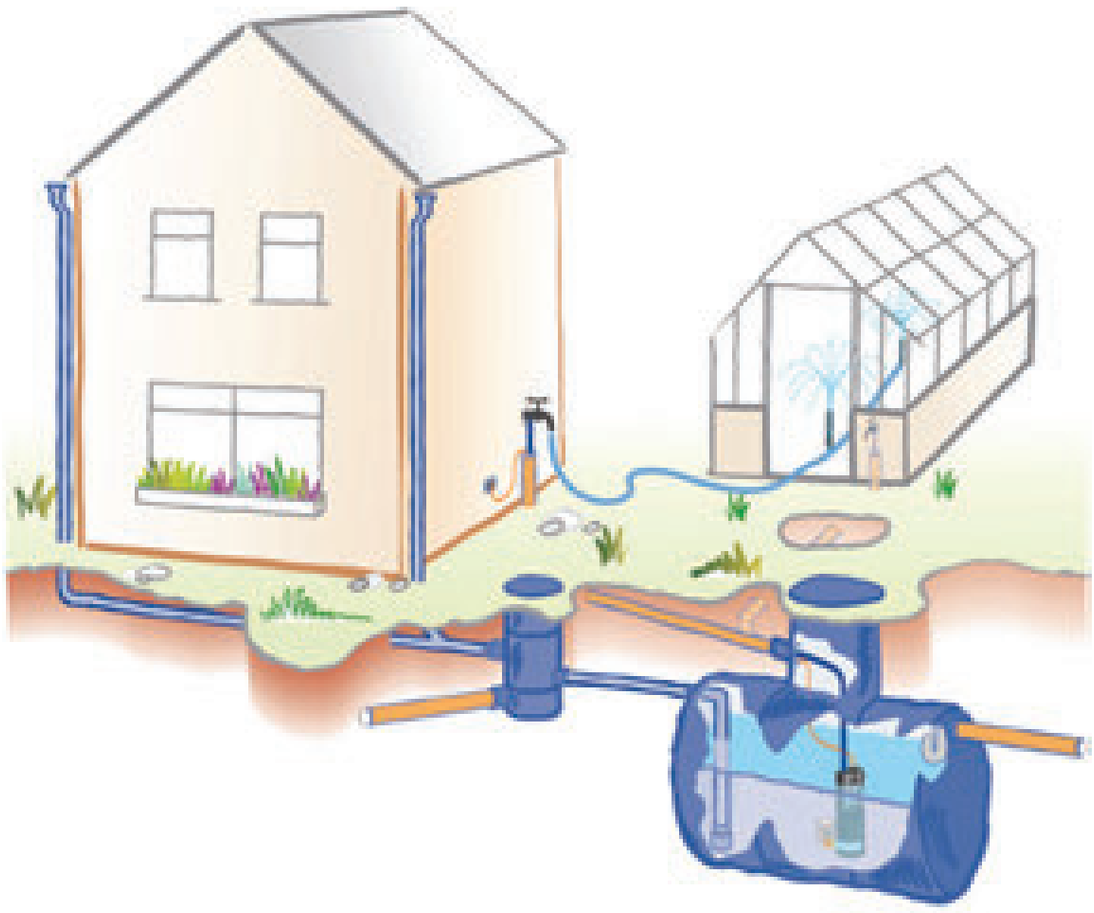
- Rainwater supplements our domestic,industrial and other water needs.
- Ground water is constantly getting depleted or polluted in large areas.
- Water is free, only cost is for collection and use.
- Rain water is sodium free and is therefore important for persons on low sodium diets.
- Rain water is superior for landscape irrigation.
- Rain water harvesting reduces consumer's utility bills.

8.2.2 Methods of Rainwater Harvesting

Broadly there are two ways of harvesting rainwater.

1. Surface runoff harvesting

In urban area rainwater flows away as surface runoff. This runoff could be caught and used for recharging aquifers by adopting appropriate methods.



XII Std - Home Science EM_Unit 8.indd 202 23-03-2020 3.32.55 PM